

Security Watch

It's a dangerous world out there full of trojans, exploits, malware and other baddies.



Smartphone kill-switches

Multiple device makers have agreed to include kill-switches in their devices to help curb thefts <http://dgit.in/SmartKill>



Apple's entry into wearable tech?

ible PCB suppliers for its next generation iWatch. The reports also suggest that Apple may launch the iWatch in the third quarter this year.

Apple has reportedly received these PCBs from Flexium Interconnect, Carrer Technology and Zhen Ding Technology Holding. Reports suggest that the tech giant will examine the parts before approving them for the iWatch. Zhen Ding is Apple's largest supplier of printed circuit boards, and plans to spend over \$100 million to add production capacity. The PCB manufacturer expects orders not only for the iWatch, but also for the iPhone 6 and iPhone phablet.

Flexium plans on spending nearly \$50 million to \$66 million to increase production of its mid-range to high-end products which will lead to a 20% increase in revenue for the company. Carrier Technology is also planning to expand production in China and Taiwan and will spend \$33 million on the project this year.

Previous reports about Apple's iWatch reveal that the wearable device may use solar panels and a magnetic induction charging mechanism. The New York Times reports, that

the solar charging technology may overcome battery life problems. NYT also says that Apple is working on wireless charging technology using magnetic induction. Apple has also filed iWatch trademarks in Japan and Russia.

Apart from Apple, Motorola and LG are also planning to launch their Android wear based smartwatches this year. Motorola Moto 360 and LG G Watch will support features like "Ok Google" assistant and will be compatible with a wide range of devices. The devices are expected to be launched over the summer.

According to other reports, Samsung is working on a new variant of its Galaxy Gear 2 smartwatch that will support integrated telephony functionality. The smartwatch will come with an integrated USIM module, that will let you make calls without the help of a synced smartphone.

Anti-theft remote kill switch coming soon to all smartphones

Google, Nokia, Samsung, HTC and Motorola, among other large phone makers, have agreed to introduce a built-in anti-theft feature in their

phones that will allow users to remotely wipe data and lock a stolen device. The feature is expected to be introduced in all smartphones after July 2015 thanks to increased pressure from American politicians. If users do manage to reclaim their lost devices then the feature will allow them to restore data that has been wiped out.

However, as per the discussions between the companies, the proposed feature will be 'opt-in' which means that users will have to actively go into their phone settings and turn it on. This could mean that users who don't have knowledge of the feature will still not turn it on or may choose not to if the feature is hidden behind scores of menus and sub-menus.

Android users can currently already remotely lock and wipe data from a stolen device by turning on

Researchers bypass the S5's fingerprint sensor

SRLabs points out that using fingerprint as credentials for local user authentication has two flaws as compared to the traditional password system.

First up is the limited revocation, which means if a fingerprint gets stolen, there's no way to change it. Second is the credential spread. "Users leave copies of their fingerprints everywhere; including on the devices they protect. Fingerprints are not fit for secure local user authentication as long as spoofs (fake fingers) can be produced from these pervasive copies," said the firm.

In the meanwhile, PayPal has issued a statement, saying the company has taken the SRLabs findings seriously.

"The scan unlocks a secure cryptographic key that serves as a password replacement for



SGS5 sensor – flawed?

Android Device Manager in their phone's settings. Apple also introduced the Activation Lock feature in iOS 7 that offers similar abilities. We're not sure how the proposed feature will differ from the existing options but if it means that the security options take centre-stage due to the proposal, then we're all for it.

the phone," the statement read. "We can simply deactivate the key from a lost or stolen device, and you can create a new one. PayPal also uses sophisticated fraud and risk management tools to try to prevent fraud before it happens. However, in the rare instances that it does, you are covered by our purchase protection policy."